

Nikolas Sung
Curriculum Vitae, September 2026

Department of Brain and Cognitive Sciences
 Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT)

niksung@mit.edu
 linkedin.com/in/nik-sung

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Applied cognitive neuroscience and psycholinguistics with a focus on semantic and syntactic processing, comprehension, and memory; Computational modeling of neuroimaging and electroencephalography (EEG) data to examine how language experience shapes brain architecture.

EDUCATION

2026 – Present	Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) Relevant Coursework: <i>9.66 Computational Cognitive Science</i>
2022 – 2026	Northwestern University B.A., Neuroscience & Linguistics Minor: Business Institutions Cumulative GPA: 3.86/4.00 Honors Thesis: <i>Tracking Bilingual Memory: How Crosslinguistic Activation Shapes the Neural Dynamics of Memory Formation</i> Awards: Finalist, Northwestern Fletcher Undergraduate Research Grant Prize; Northwestern Summer Undergraduate Research Grant (\$4,000); Weinberg College Baker Program Conference Travel Grant (\$500); Office of Undergraduate Research Conference Travel Grant (\$500); Dean's List

POSITIONS

2026 – Present	K. Lisa Yang Post-Baccalaureate Research Scholar, MIT <i>EvLab</i> Advisor: Evelina Fedorenko, PhD
2024 – Present	Undergraduate Research Assistant, Northwestern University <i>Bilingualism and Psycholinguistics Research Lab</i> Advisor: Viorica Marian, PhD
2026 – 2026	Undergraduate Talent Attraction Research Assistant, University of Granada <i>Memory and Language Group</i> Advisor: M ^a Teresa Bajo, PhD Award: University of Granada Undergraduate Talent Acquisition Grant (€2,000)
2023 – 2024	Summer Research Assistant Intern, University of Iowa <i>The Boes Lab</i> Advisor: Aaron Boes, MD, PhD

PUBLICATIONS

Reverse chron.

Sung, N., & López-Rojas, C. (in review). When to switch, when to remember: What language-switching practice changes in bilinguals' future intentions. *Ciencia Cognitiva*. Published online. (Science outreach)

Soto, C., López-Rojas, C., Chung-Fat-Yim, A., **Sung, N.**, & Marian, V. (in prep.). Bilingual Co-Activation Shapes Memory Encoding and Retrieval: Evidence from EEG and Eye-Tracking Co-Registration.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Reverse chron.

Soto, C., López-Rojas, C., Chung-Fat-Yim, A., **Sung, N.**, Juarez, G., & Marian, V. (2026 November).

“Bilingual Co-Activation Shapes Memory Formation and Retrieval: Evidence from EEG and Eye-Tracking Co-Registration” [Poster Presentation] in the Psychonomic Society 67th Annual Meeting, San Diego, CA

Soto, C., López-Rojas, C., Chung-Fat-Yim, A., Reilly, R., **Sung, N.**, Juarez, G., & Marian, V. (2026 October).

“Co-Registering Eye Movements and ERPs Reveals How Bilingual Co-Activation Shapes Memory” [Poster Presentation] in the 2026 UIC Bilingualism Forum, Chicago, IL

Soto, C., Reilly, R., Chung-Fat-Yim, A., **Sung, N.**, Biju, J., Juarez, G., & Marian, V. (2026 June).

“Phonological overlap across languages boosts semantic associations in bilinguals: An eye-tracking and EEG co-registration study” [Oral Presentation] in the 35th Annual Conference of the European Second Language Association, Lisbon, Portugal

Soto, C., Chung-Fat-Yim, A., **Sung, N.**, & Marian, V. (2025 November). “Looking for Potential: A Framework for Co-Registering Eye Movements and ERPs in Bilingualism Research” [Poster Presentation] in the Psychonomic Society 66th Annual Meeting, Denver, CO

Soto, C., Chung-Fat-Yim, A., **Sung, N.**, & Marian, V. (2025 June). “Vino, beer and beans: An eye-tracking and EEG co-registration recipe for how phonological overlap across languages boosts semantic associations in bilinguals” [Poster Presentation] in the 15th International Symposium of Bilingualism, Donostia-San Sebastián, Spain

Soto, C., **Sung, N.**, Biju, J., Chung-Fat-Yim, A., & Marian, V. (2025 May). “Tracking Meaning: The Role of Phonological Overlap in Bilingual Semantic Networks” [Poster Presentation] in the 2025 Cognitive neuroscience of individual differences in adult language learning: Future directions Conference, Chicago, IL

Sung, N., Soto, C.*, Chung-Fat-Yim, A., & Marian, V. (2025 April). “Unrelated yet connected: How phonological overlap across languages rewires semantic associations in bilinguals” [Poster Presentation] in the 97th Annual Midwestern Psychological Association Conference, Chicago, IL

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCES

2026 – 2026	Director for Weinberg College of Arts and Sciences, <i>Northwestern University Office of Student Transition Experiences (OSTE)</i>
2024 – 2026	Chapter President, <i>The Youth Movement Against Alzheimer’s (YMAA)</i>
2023 – 2026	Public Relations Chair, <i>Northwestern University Neuro Club</i>

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

2024 – 2026	Memory Care Volunteer, <i>The Pearl of Evanston</i>
2024 – 2026	Brain Health & Leadership Trainee, <i>Hilarity for Charity</i>
2023 – 2026	Assisted Living & Memory Care Volunteer, <i>Trulee Evanston</i> , Evanston, IL

LANGUAGES & SKILLS

Languages: Korean (native), English (native), French (basic reading and speaking)

Technical: R, Python (PsychoPy), MATLAB (EEGLAB/ERPLAB), JASP (ANOVA)

Certifications: CITI Program Biomedical Research